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01 Project Launch Packet

Start Assignment

Due

Sunday by 11:59pm

Points

100

Submitting

a text entry box, a website url, a media recording, or a file upload

Available

after May 9 at 12am

1. Assignment

This assignment launches the CISC 699 applied-project sequence. You will move from a broad interest area to a credible candidate project that is technically feasible, academically appropriate, and supportable within a 14-week timeline. The goal is not to prove that the project is already solved; the goal is to frame a problem worth solving, identify a plausible solution path, and establish an initial working relationship with the assigned supervisor.

Your submission must show that you understand the problem domain, can articulate who the stakeholders are, can identify the computational artifact you expect to build, and can explain what evidence would count as project success. You are expected to begin documenting the project in a disciplined way from the first week.

2. Tasks and Step-by-Step Technical Instructions

- Review the course shell, syllabus, grading logic, milestone calendar, and submission conventions. Record the seven hard-stop dates in your personal project calendar.
- Meet or communicate with the instructor and assigned supervisor to confirm the broad project domain, likely artifact type, and any organizational or sponsor constraints.
- Draft a one-paragraph problem statement that identifies the user, operational context, pain point, and why the problem matters now.
- Generate three candidate project ideas, then compare them by feasibility, data/tool availability, technical risk, novelty, and fit with your background.
- Select one candidate project and produce a project charter draft that includes working title, project rationale, intended artifact, likely users, initial scope boundaries, and known assumptions.
- Create the project workspace: version-control repository, top-level folder structure, issue tracker, and a running engineering log or journal.
- Start an annotated bibliography with at least five credible technical or scholarly sources. Each annotation should state the source's relevance to your project.
- Complete a first-pass feasibility review covering data availability, compute needs, software dependencies, deployment expectations, and time constraints.
- Write a short supervisor briefing note that lists the decisions still needed from the Week 1 conversation.
- Submit the launch packet as a single organized package and be prepared to revise the charter immediately after feedback.

3. Tools (Machine, Architectures, Computational, and API)

Tool Dimension	Recommended Baseline	Suggested Options / Variants	Evidence Student Should Submit
Machine	Personal laptop or workstation; reliable file backup; editor or IDE; browser; cloud or local storage with versioned copies.	Windows/macOS/Linux; optional GPU or university lab access if the project is compute-intensive.	Screenshot of environment, repository URL or screenshot, folder structure, and basic environment inventory.
Architectures	Initial project workspace, repo structure, issue board, and a simple system context view.	C4 context diagram, UML use-case view, ER sketch, data-flow sketch, or service boundary map.	One architecture/context diagram and a short explanation of scope boundaries.
Computational	Working language/runtime choice and basic project template.	Python, Java, C#, JavaScript/TypeScript, R, SQL, notebooks, simulation stack, or analytics stack.	Readme stub, environment file, starter notebook or starter application skeleton.
API	Inventory of external systems, libraries, datasets, and services the project may depend on.	REST APIs, SDKs, database connectors, model APIs, scraping interfaces, data portals, or message brokers.	Table of intended APIs/services with access status and dependency notes.

4. Readings and Resources for the Tasks and the Tools

Task-Focused Readings and Resources	Tool-Focused Readings and Resources
- Course syllabus and the Canvas orientation pages for CISC 699. - GRAD 695 notes on problem statements, project scoping, and academic writing conventions. - Project charter templates used in software or systems projects. - Recent scholarly or technical sources that define the domain problem and its practical significance.	- Git and GitHub/GitLab fundamentals for repository setup and issue tracking. - IDE or notebook quick-start documentation for the selected language/runtime. - Documentation for any candidate API, SDK, dataset, or compute platform under consideration. - Diagramming references for C4, UML, or data-flow modeling.

5. Extras to Help the Student Finish Properly

Instructor / Student Success Extras
- Suggested submission package: project charter draft, annotated bibliography, feasibility memo, architecture/context sketch, and workspace screenshots. - Common failure mode: choosing a project that is interesting but impossible to validate in 14 weeks

- Supervisor prompt: What is the minimum viable artifact that would still count as a successful master's applied project? - Student self-check: Can you explain the project in under two minutes to both a technical and a non-technical audience?

RU-01 Project Launch Packet					
Criteria	Ratings				Pts
1. Project Selection and Problem Fit	20 to >18.0 pts Level 1 – Advanced / Exceptional (90–100%) Selects a high-value, feasible CS problem with a clearly justified applied or research need; alignment with program outcomes and likely supervisor expertise is explicit.	18 to >16.0 pts Level 2 – Proficient / Competent (80–89%) Selects a relevant project with good justification and acceptable fit to the course and supervisor; feasibility is mostly convincing.	16 to >12.0 pts Level 3 – Approaching Proficiency / Developing (70–79%) Project idea is serviceable but narrow, vague, or weakly justified; feasibility and fit require instructor guidance.	12 to >0 pts Level 4 – Beginning / Emerging (0–69%) Project selection is poorly defined, impractical, off-scope, or unsupported by a clear need.	20 pts
2. Project Charter and Scope Framing	20 to >18.0 pts Level 1 – Advanced / Exceptional (90–100%) Charter is complete, precise, and internally consistent; goals, constraints, assumptions, stakeholders, risks, and success criteria are sharply framed.	18 to >16.0 pts Level 2 – Proficient / Competent (80–89%) Charter is complete and logical with only minor omissions or ambiguities; scope is workable.	16 to >12.0 pts Level 3 – Approaching Proficiency / Developing (70–79%) Charter covers basic elements but leaves key gaps in scope, goals, assumptions, or constraints.	12 to >0 pts Level 4 – Beginning / Emerging (0–69%) Charter is incomplete, inconsistent, or fails to define the project in usable terms	20 pts
3. Feasibility, Resources, and Technical Readiness	20 to >18.0 pts Level 1 – Advanced / Exceptional (90–100%) Demonstrates rigorous early feasibility across machine, architecture, computational method, and API/tool options; risks and dependencies are realistically anticipated.	18 to >16.0 pts Level 2 – Proficient / Competent (80–89%) Identifies plausible technical path, tools, and dependencies; feasibility is reasonable though not fully stress-tested.	16 to >12.0 pts Level 3 – Approaching Proficiency / Developing (70–79%) Provides partial feasibility thinking but misses important technical dependencies, constraints, or resource needs.	12 to >0 pts Level 4 – Beginning / Emerging (0–69%) Shows little evidence of technical readiness or feasibility analysis.	20 pts
4. Initial Bibliography and Professional Communication	20 to >18.0 pts Level 1 – Advanced / Exceptional (90–100%) Initial bibliography is current, credible, and well-curated; writing is professional, well organized, and publication-aware.	18 to >16.0 pts Level 2 – Proficient / Competent (80–89%) Bibliography is relevant and mostly credible; writing and organization are clear and professional.	16 to >12.0 pts Level 3 – Approaching Proficiency / Developing (70–79%) Bibliography is thin, uneven, or partly irrelevant; writing needs improvement in clarity or structure.	12 to >0 pts Level 4 – Beginning / Emerging (0–69%) Sources are weak, missing, or inappropriate; communication is disorganized or unprofessional.	20 pts
5. AI Usage Log and Academic Integrity	20 to >18.0 pts Level 1 – Advanced / Exceptional (90–100%) All AI use is fully disclosed in the AI Usage Log with precise in-text acknowledgments where relevant; human-authored judgment and originality are unmistakable.	18 to >16.0 pts Level 2 – Proficient / Competent (80–89%) AI use is disclosed appropriately with only minor gaps in annotation or reflection.	16 to >12.0 pts Level 3 – Approaching Proficiency / Developing (70–79%) AI disclosure is incomplete, vague, or inconsistent with the submitted work.	12 to >0 pts Level 4 – Beginning / Emerging (0–69%) AI use is undisclosed, misleading, prohibited where used, or raises integrity concerns.	20 pts
Total Points: 100					